AI Agents as Interviewers

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How to write good specs?

CHAPTER 1 OF 3

01

The Problem

If the spec is vague, the agent does not stop.

It fills the gaps.



Who it’s for



Which risks matter



Which trade-offs



Which words

...while the real answers stay

in the team's heads.

THIS TALK

GITHUB SPEC KIT AND FRIENDS



CHAPTER 2 OF 3

02

Coding Agents as Interviewers



github.com/donlelef/interviewing-talk

Add upvoting to questions.

Who upvotes?

Own questions?

How many?

Undo?

Downvotes?

Reorder?

Add upvoting to questions.

A budget?

Who sees counts?

Answered ones?

Duplicates?

Cheating?

Vote or upvote?

0 Just Build

```
Add upvoting to questions.
```

→

```
SET votes = votes + 1
```

- ✓ It works.
- ✗ Every decision is a silent guess.

1 Ask Me Questions

✓ Better than guessing.

✗ Too much at once.

AGENT

Before I start, a few questions:

1. Who should be able to upvote?
2. Should upvotes be anonymous?
3. Do you also want downvotes?
4. Should the list reorder by votes?
5. Do you want real-time updates?
6. How should we migrate the schema?
7. Should we add rate limiting?
8. What test coverage do you expect?

...and six more.

2 One at a Time

- ✅ Easy to answer.
- ❌ No opinion.

AGENT

Who can upvote a question?

A Anyone, as often as they like

B One upvote per browser

C One upvote per nickname

D Signed-in users only

3 Sparring Partner

✓ It has an opinion.

✗ It forgets it when the chat ends.

AGENT

Who can upvote a question?

A Anyone, as often as they like

B One upvote per browser **Recommended**

A sign-in step would lose most of a live room. Good enough to stop double clicks.

C One upvote per nickname

D Signed-in users only

4 Grill with Docs

- Questions in rounds.
- **Answers in the repo.**

ROUND 1

1. Who upvotes?	Recommended: a browser
2. Downvotes?	Recommended: none



```
docs/
  PRODUCT.md
  GLOSSARY.md
  ARCHITECTURE.md
  decisions/0001–….md
```

The interview leaves memory, not code.

`docs/GLOSSARY.md`

Attendee

A person in the audience, recognised by their browser.

Avoid: ~~user~~ · ~~participant~~ · ~~voter~~

`docs/decisions/0001`

Attendees are anonymous browsers

Rejected: ~~sign-in~~ · ~~nickname~~ · ~~IP address~~

		Asks before coding	One question at a time, with options	Recommends, with trade-offs	Writes the answers down
0	Just Build	○	○	○	○
1	Ask Me Questions	●	○	○	○
2	One at a Time	●	●	○	○
3	Sparring Partner	●	●	●	○
4	Grill with Docs	●	●	●	●

CHAPTER 3 OF 3

03

Take-Home Messages

1 Interview before you build.

2 Ask for a recommendation, not a menu.

3 Write the answers into the repo.

EGO SLIDE

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Professor in AI at the Catholic University of Milan; guest lecturer at PoliMI, UniPV, EPFL and Politechnika Wrocławska.

PhD in Applied AI, with 9 peer-reviewed papers and 180+ citations.

Speaker at 40+ international conferences, including AMLD Lausanne, ODSC London, WeAreDevelopers Berlin, PyData Berlin, Paris and Milan, PyCon Italy, Swiss Python Summit, Codemotion.

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